

Privileged Access Governance at Scale

Azure RBAC and PIM governance across hundreds of security groups and thousands of users.

385

Azure subscriptions

100s

Security groups

1000s

Users in scope

PIM

Time-bound access
model

CONTEXT

A large enterprise Azure environment had accumulated significant standing privileged access through traditional RBAC assignments and group-based access models. At this scale, permanent privileged access increases security risk, complicates periodic reviews and makes it harder to maintain a consistent and auditable access model.

SCOPE

A defined privileged-access governance workstream spanning Microsoft Entra ID, Azure RBAC and Privileged Identity Management across **hundreds of security groups** and **thousands of users**. The scope focused specifically on privileged-access governance rather than broad IAM ownership.

KEY WORK

- Analysed existing RBAC assignments, group membership and privileged-access patterns across the Azure estate.
- Designed a scalable model for transitioning appropriate standing access to PIM-managed eligible access.
- Defined governance rules for privileged roles, activation and periodic access review.
- Developed automation to support large-scale migration and ongoing privileged-access governance.
- Coordinated migration of access represented through hundreds of security groups and thousands of user memberships.
- Introduced repeatable review, validation and audit processes.

OUTCOMES

- **Access model:** transitioned large-scale privileged access from standing RBAC toward time-bound, PIM-managed access.
- **Scale:** applied the model across hundreds of security groups and thousands of users.
- **Risk reduction:** reduced permanent privileged access and improved visibility of role eligibility and activation.
- **Governance:** established repeatable access reviews, validation and stronger auditability.
- **Automation:** reduced manual governance effort through standardised processes and tooling.

TECHNOLOGY

Microsoft Entra ID

Azure RBAC
Privileged Identity Management
Management Groups
PowerShell
Azure Resource Graph
Azure DevOps
ServiceNow API